

Zeyi Qian (钱则一)

📍 950 Main Street, Worcester, Massachusetts, 01610 | ✉ zeqian@clarku.edu | 🔗 <https://zeyiqian.github.io/>

Education

Clark University, Worcester, Massachusetts, United States

PhD in Economics

2026 (Expected)

Advisors: Junfu Zhang (Co-Chair), Kensuke Suzuki (Co-Chair), and Shihe Fu

Clark University, Worcester, Massachusetts, United States

MA in Economics

2023

Shanghai University, Shanghai, China

MA in Economics

2021

Shanghai Ocean University, Shanghai, China

BA in Economics

2018

University of Toronto, Toronto, Ontario, Canada

International Visiting Graduate Student

2019-2020

Working Papers & Works in Progress

Trade Costs, Entry Costs, and Regional Economic Growth in China (Job Market Paper) [Download](#) 

Joint with Kensuke Suzuki and Junfu Zhang

This paper examines sectoral growth patterns across Chinese provinces during the country's economic takeoff in the early 2000s, following major policy reforms including trade liberalization, infrastructure expansion, business climate improvements, and relaxed rural-to-urban migration restrictions. We develop a multi-sector, multi-region spatial general equilibrium model with heterogeneous firms *à la* **Melitz-Chaney** to analyze how these reforms interacted to shape regional economic growth. We quantify the model for the Chinese economy and conduct counterfactuals to identify the key mechanisms driving regional development. We find that reductions in trade costs and lowered entry barriers facilitate firm entry and intensify competition. Together, these factors shape regional specialization and China's overall economic growth. Our decomposition exercises reveal that lowered business entry costs played a larger role than the reduction in trade costs in promoting the growth of real wages, especially in inland provinces. This operates through a selection effect, where more productive firms expand and force the least productive ones to exit, and through increased variety, which effectively lowers the price index.

Aging Economy and Comparative Advantage: A Quantitative Analysis of Japan

Joint with Kensuke Suzuki and Junfu Zhang

This paper examines how an aging population reshapes comparative advantage, using Japan as an example. We propose that demographic change shifts comparative advantage toward experience-reliant sectors employing more older workers, causing significant structural transformation of the national economy. We construct a spatial general equilibrium model based on the **Krugman** framework, calibrated with detailed Japanese firm-level and task-level data, to identify which industries are more suitable for older workers and which regions are better positioned to expand in these elderly-intensive sectors. Counterfactual analysis shows that relaxing young worker immigration mitigates the decline of young-worker-intensive sectors, while encouraging elderly employment accelerates the shift toward elderly-oriented sectors. The model compares the relative effectiveness of these policies and examines how automation/AI can offset aging's economic effects, highlighting their impacts on welfare.

Breaking Barriers: Regional Economic Integration and National Market Unification [Download](#) 

Available at SSRN 5934310. Submitted. Joint with Haoyun Zhao

Venture Capital Network and Innovation of New Scientific and Technological Enterprises: An Information Broker's Perspective (in Chinese)

The Journal of World Economy (世界经济) R&R. Joint with Qiangyuan Chen, Huirong Li, and Yihua Yu

Government Procurement and Firm Development: Selection, Promotion, and Its Macroeconomic Effects (in Chinese)

The Journal of Quantitative & Technical Economics (数量经济技术经济研究) R&R. Joint with Xiaoping Li, Haoyun

Zhao, and Feitao Jiang

Do Firms Choose Distant Relocation Under Environmental Pressure? Evidence from the Chinese Paper Industry

Submitted. Joint with Haoyun Zhao

The Persistent Influence of Ancient Institutions: Evidence from the Spatial Distribution of Yazhang in China

Submitted

Leisure Demand and Pastime Trade

Joint with Shihe Fu

Borders within Borders: A Quantitative Spatial Analysis of the Hainan Free Trade Port

Joint with Nick Zitao Wang and Ruiqian Wang

Trade Shock and Dynamic Labor Allocation

Publications

How City Size Affects Firm Survival: Evidence from Chinese Enterprise Registration Data [Download](#)

Applied Economics Letters, 2025, 1-5. Joint with Haoyun Zhao, Yameng Guo, and Yang Ye

Estimating Round-Tripping FDI from Firm-Level Data in China [Download](#)

International Studies of Economics (Frontiers of Economics in China), 2025, **20**(2): 138-152. Joint with Junfu Zhang and Qiangyuan Chen

The Spatiotemporal Evolution of Talent Policies and Their Impact on New Quality Productive Forces in Chinese Prefecture-Level Cities: Based on Quantitative Analysis of 3308 Policy Texts from 2002 to 2021 (in Chinese) [Download](#)

Studies in Science of Science (科学学研究), 2025, **44**(2), 255-269+372. Joint with Yang Ye, Jie Xu, and Zhanglong Huang

International Twin Cities and Chinese Export Activities (in Chinese) [Download](#)

Economic Theory and Business Management (经济理论与经济管理), 2022, **42**(3), 100-112. Joint with Jingyu Yang and Qiangyuan Chen

Promotion Effect of FDI on Enterprise Survival in Host Country—A Discussion on Industry Safety and Market Access of Foreign Investment (in Chinese) [Download](#)

China Industrial Economics (中国工业经济), 2021, (7), 137-155. Joint with Qiangyuan Chen, Yu Chen, and Zhenhuai Shi

The Man-Bear Race: A New Explanation of Regional Competition for China's High-Speed Rail Stations (in Chinese) [Download](#)

South China Journal of Economics (南方经济), 2021, **40**(2), 66-83. Joint with Qiangyuan Chen, Zhenhuai Shi, and Xiaoping Li

Presentations

2026 (Scheduled): Chinese Economists Society North America Annual Conference (Emory University), Graduate Student Seminar (Clark University)

2025: Siyuan Forum (Shanghai University of International Business and Economics, Virtual), Southern Economic Association Annual Meeting (Tampa, FL), Midwest International Trade & Theory Conference (Pennsylvania State University), Annual Meetings of the Midwest Economics Association (Kansas City, MO), Graduate Student Seminar (Clark University)

2024: Graduate Student Seminar (Clark University)

2023: Chinese Economist Society North American Conference (University of Oklahoma), Graduate Student Seminar (Clark University)

2022: Graduate Student Seminar (Clark University)

2020: Camphor Economic Circle Seminar (University of Chinese Academy of Social Sciences)

2019: Academic Forum on Regional Science and Urban Economics (Shanghai University of Finance and Economics), Shanghai Postgraduate Academic Forum (University of Shanghai for Science and Technology), Forum on Frontier of International Trade Theory and Demonstration (Southwestern University of Finance and Economics), Urban Development Forum (Renmin University of China), Innovation Forum (Shandong University of Finance and Economics), National Development Youth Forum (Peking University)

Teaching Experience

Clark University

Teaching Assistant, ECON 224 <i>Applied Game Theory</i> (undergraduate)	Spring 2026
Teaching Assistant, ECON 265 <i>Econometrics</i> (undergraduate)	Fall 2025 & Spring 2025
Teaching Assistant, ECON 160 <i>Introduction to Statistical Analysis</i> (undergraduate)	Fall 2024

Research Experience

Clark University

Research Assistant to Junfu Zhang, David Cuberes, Jon Denton-Schneider, and Kensuke Suzuki	2021-2024
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Renmin University of China

Research Assistant to Qiangyuan Chen	Winter 2018-Summer 2021
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University of Toronto

Research Assistant to Yao Luo	Winter 2019 & Spring 2020
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Referee Services

International Studies of Economics (Frontiers of Economics in China)

Selected Awards & Grants

E. C. H. Veendorp Best Field Paper Award, Clark University	2024
Sheftel Travel Award, Clark University	2023-2026
National Scholarship, Ministry of Education of China	2019
Shanghai Municipal Scholarship, Shanghai Municipal Education Commission	2017
IER Project Research Grant (IERPK2527, PI: Motoaki Takahashi), Hitotsubashi University, Japan	2025-2027
NSFC Grant (72073093, PI: Qiangyuan Chen), National Natural Science Foundation of China	2021-2024
Shanghai Municipal Government Consulting Project Grant (2018-Z-D02, PI: Qiangyuan Chen), Pudong New Area Government, Shanghai	2018-2019

References

Junfu Zhang

John T. Croteau Professor and Chair of Economics
Department of Economics
Clark University
juzhang@clarku.edu

Shihe Fu

Professor of Economics
Economics and Management School
Wuhan University
fushihe@whu.edu.cn

Kensuke Suzuki

Assistant Professor of Economics
Department of Economics
Clark University
ksuzuki@clarku.edu

Qiangyuan Chen

Professor of Economics
National Academy of Development and Strategy
Renmin University of China
chqiangy@126.com

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